



Presented by The High End

CARDBOARD FIRE TRUCK CAB

Life-Size Sit-In Fire Truck — Roofed Cab, Hood, 4 Wheels, Light Bar & Firefighter Helmet

Build the fire truck. Wear the helmet. Save the living room.

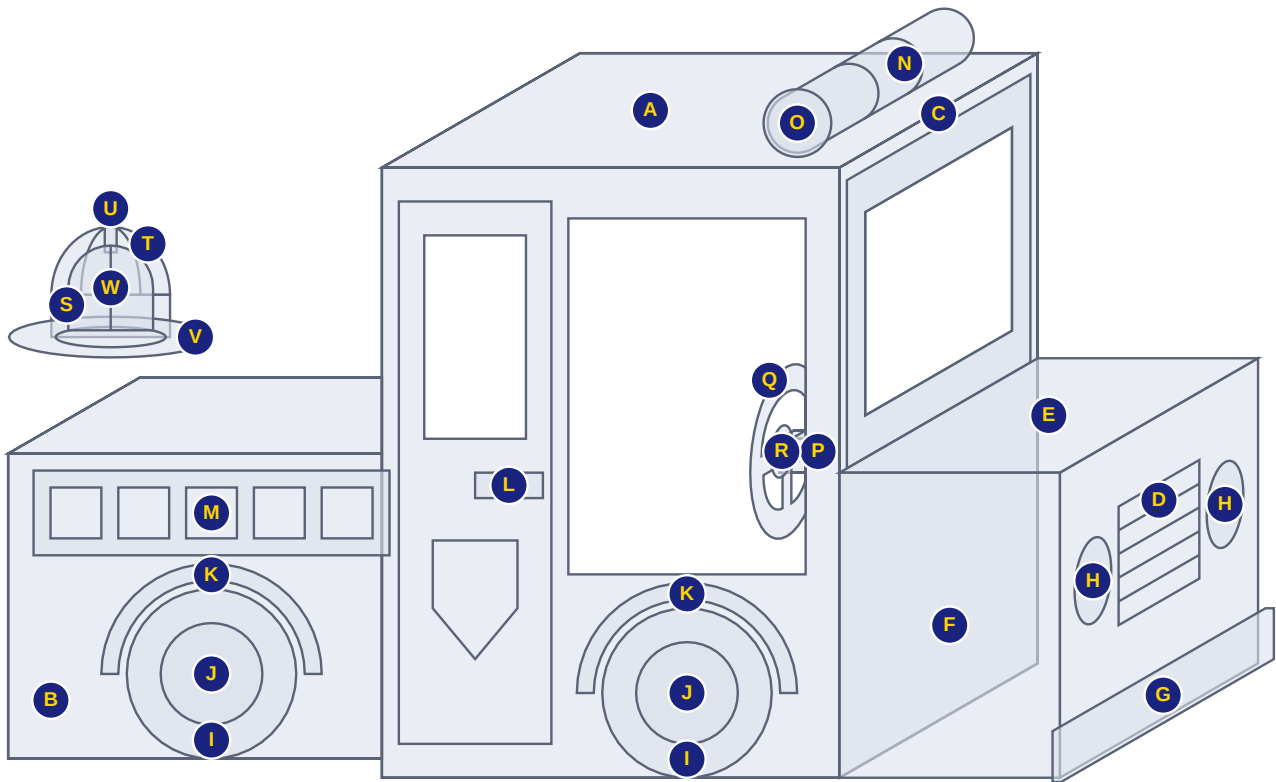
AGES 3–10	BOXES 4 Boxes	TIME 4–5 Hours	DIFF Intermediate **	PIECES 23 pcs
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CARDBOARD NEEDED:
4 Boxes (2 at least 24" × 36" (61 × 91 cm) + 2 used whole)
FINISHED SIZE:
64" long × 28" wide × 40" tall with the light bar (163 × 71 × 102 cm); helmet fits heads 19.5–22.5"

MISSION GOAL:
Build the truck in the photo: a roofed cab with door windows, handles and badges; a hood with grille, headlights and bumper; 4 wheels in arches; a ladder body; a striped light bar; a 3-spoke wheel; and a domed helmet.

HOW IT ALL GOES TOGETHER — CARDBOARD FIRE TRUCK CAB

The finished build, from the front left, like the cover photo (helmet drawn beside it, from the front), with every part in the place the steps put it and the letter from its own cut-template page. Parts are drawn at their real size relative to each other, so if a letter is on this picture there is a page for it in this file. Pieces that roll into a tube are shown rolled, not laid flat.

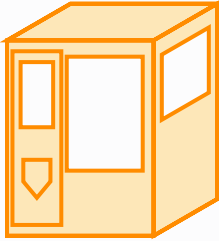


EVERY PART IN THIS BUILD					
A	CAB BOX (FULL BOX) 27" × 36" (69 × 91 cm)	CUT x1	B	REAR BODY (FULL BOX) 24" × 18" (61 × 46 cm)	CUT x1
C	WINDSHIELD FRAME 25" × 17" (64 × 43 cm)	CUT x1	D	HOOD FRONT 27" × 18" (69 × 46 cm)	CUT x1
E	HOOD TOP 27" × 13" (69 × 33 cm)	CUT x1	F	HOOD SIDE 13" × 18" (33 × 46 cm)	CUT x2
G	BUMPER 29" × 6" (74 × 15 cm)	CUT x1	H	HEADLIGHT 5" × 5" (13 × 13 cm)	CUT x2
I	ROAD WHEEL 10" × 10" (25 × 25 cm)	CUT x4	J	HUBCAP 6" × 6" (15 × 15 cm)	CUT x4
K	WHEEL ARCH 13" × 6.5" (33 × 17 cm)	CUT x4	L	DOOR HANDLE 4" × 3" (10 × 8 cm)	CUT x2
M	LADDER 21" × 5" (53 × 13 cm)	CUT x2	N	LIGHT BAR TUBE 20" × 12" (51 × 30 cm)	CUT x1
O	LIGHT BAR CAP 4" × 4" (10 × 10 cm)	CUT x2	P	STEERING COLUMN 8" × 8" (20 × 20 cm)	CUT x1
Q	STEERING WHEEL LAYER 10" × 10" (25 × 25 cm)	CUT x2	R	STEERING HUB 3" × 3" (8 × 8 cm)	CUT x1
S	HELMET BAND 23" × 3.5" (58 × 9 cm)	CUT x1	T	HELMET DOME PANEL 4" × 7" (10 × 18 cm)	CUT x6
U	HELMET RIDGE 10" × 5" (25 × 13 cm)	CUT x1	V	HELMET BRIM 12" × 14" (30 × 36 cm)	CUT x1
W	HELMET BADGE PLATE 5" × 5" (13 × 13 cm)	CUT x1			

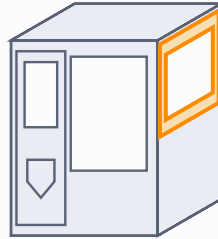
BUILD SEQUENCE — WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE AFTER EACH STEP

Each picture is the build once that step is finished. The part you just added is the ORANGE one. Grey is what was already there. Work down the page and yours should look like each picture in turn.

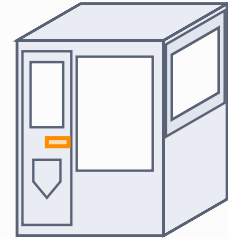
3 SET UP THE CAB BOX



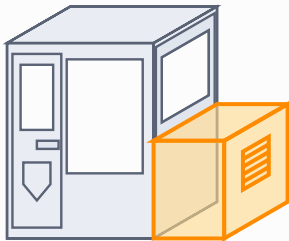
4 FIT THE WINDSHIELD FRAME



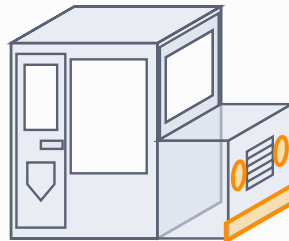
5 ADD THE DOOR HANDLES



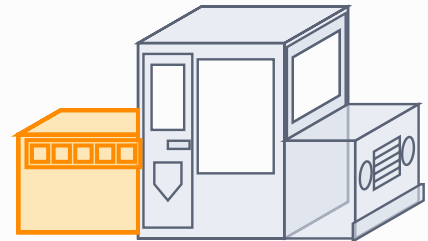
6 BUILD THE HOOD



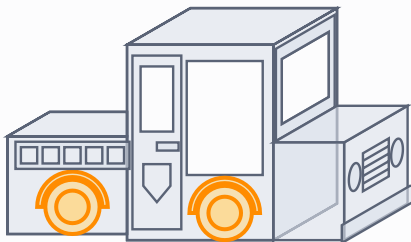
7 ADD THE BUMPER AND HEADLIGHTS



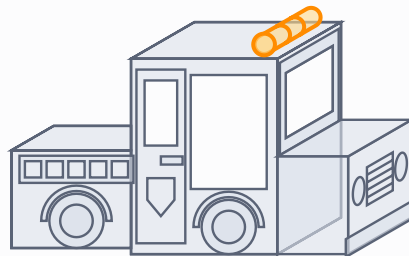
8 ADD THE REAR BODY



9 FIT THE WHEELS



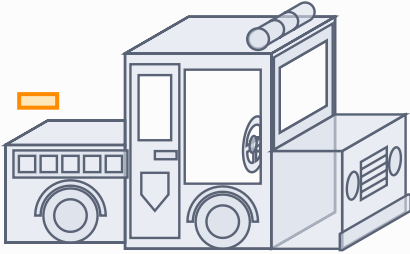
10 MOUNT THE LIGHT BAR



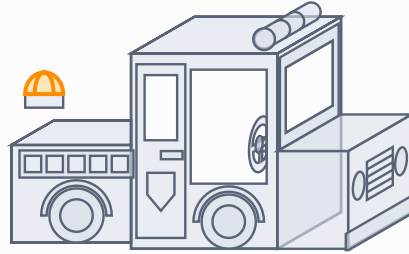
11 BUILD THE STEERING WHEEL



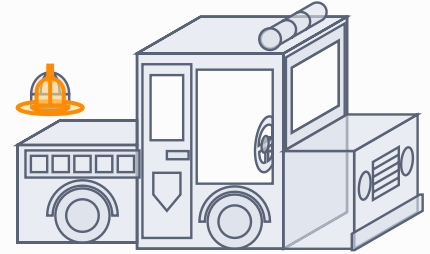
14 BUILD THE HELMET BAND

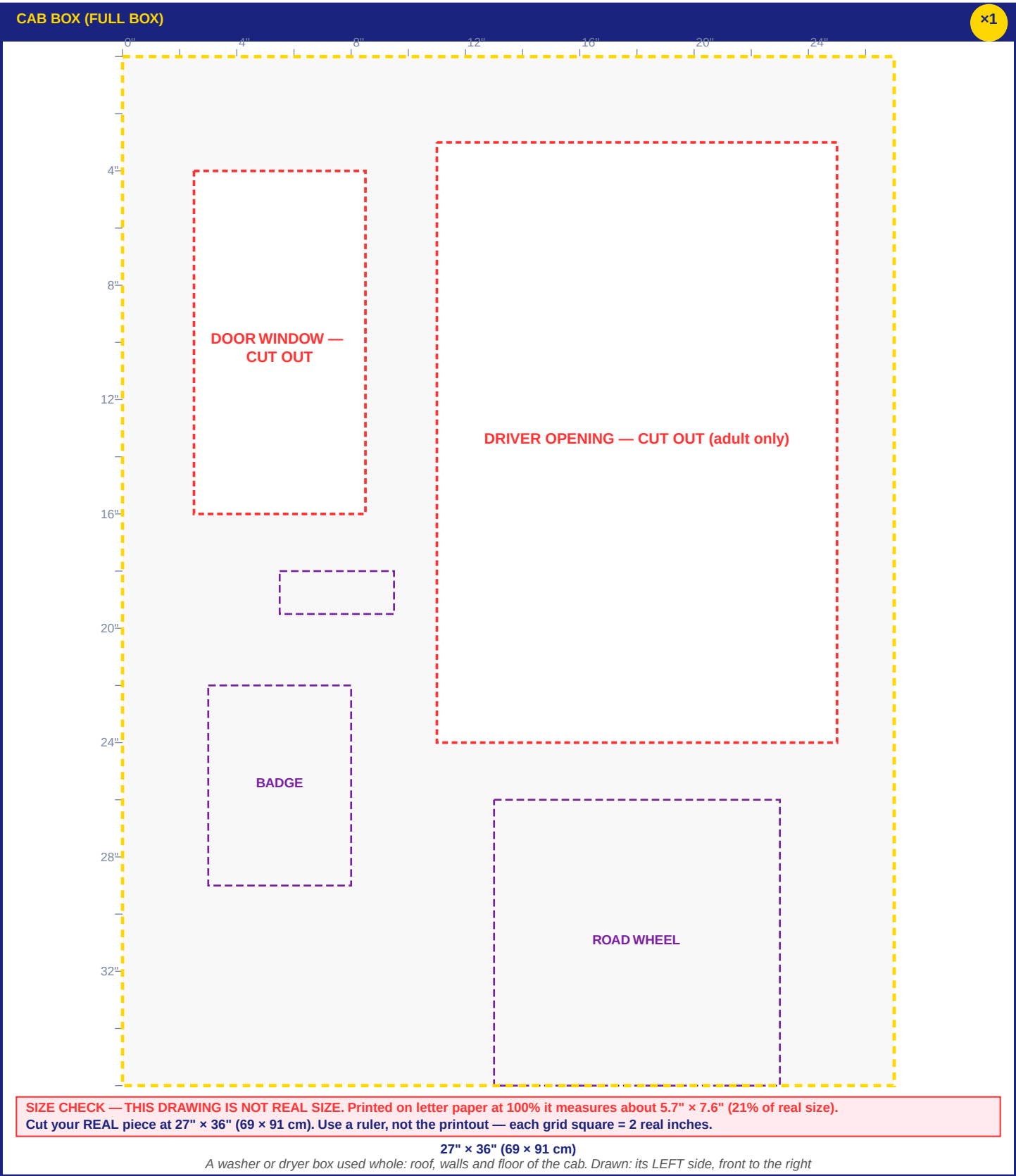


15 BUILD THE HELMET DOME



16 ADD THE BRIM, RIDGE AND BADGE PLATE





MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

CUT OUT — cut along the red dashes (an orange side is a fold)	GLUE HERE — where another part goes
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NOTE: A washer or dryer box used whole: roof, walls and floor of the cab. Drawn: its LEFT side, front to the right



REAR BODY (FULL BOX)

24" × 18" (61 × 46 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

REAR BODY (FULL BOX)

x1

0"

4"

8"

12"

16"

20"

4"

8"

12"

16"

LADDER

ROAD WHEEL

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 5.5" (30% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 24" × 18" (61 × 46 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

24" × 18" (61 × 46 cm)
A moving box about 24" × 18" × 18", used whole: the back of the truck. Drawn: its left side

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GLUE HERE — where another part goes

NOTE: A moving box about 24" × 18" × 18", used whole: the back of the truck. Drawn: its left side



WINDSHIELD FRAME

25" × 17" (64 × 43 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT

x1

WINDSHIELD FRAME

x1



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 4.9" (29% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 25" × 17" (64 × 43 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

25" × 17" (64 × 43 cm)

Glues on the front of the cab — and is the stencil for the windshield hole

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

CUT OUT — cut along the red dashes (an orange side is a fold)

NOTE: Glues on the front of the cab — and is the stencil for the windshield hole



HOOD FRONT

27" × 18" (69 × 46 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

HOOD FRONT

×1

0"

4"

8"

12"

16"

20"

24"

4"

3"

12"

16"

LIGHT

GRILLE (paint)

LIGHT

BUMPER

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 4.9" (27% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 27" × 18" (69 × 46 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

27" × 18" (69 × 46 cm)
The front of the truck: grille, headlights and bumper go on it

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GLUE HERE — where another part goes

NOTE: The front of the truck: grille, headlights and bumper go on it



HOOD TOP

27" × 13" (69 × 33 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

HOOD TOP

x1

0"

4"

8"

12"

16"

20"

24"

4"

8"

12"

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 3.5" (27% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 27" × 13" (69 × 33 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

27" × 13" (69 × 33 cm)
The top of the hood, in front of the windshield

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

CUT — scissors or box cutter on this line

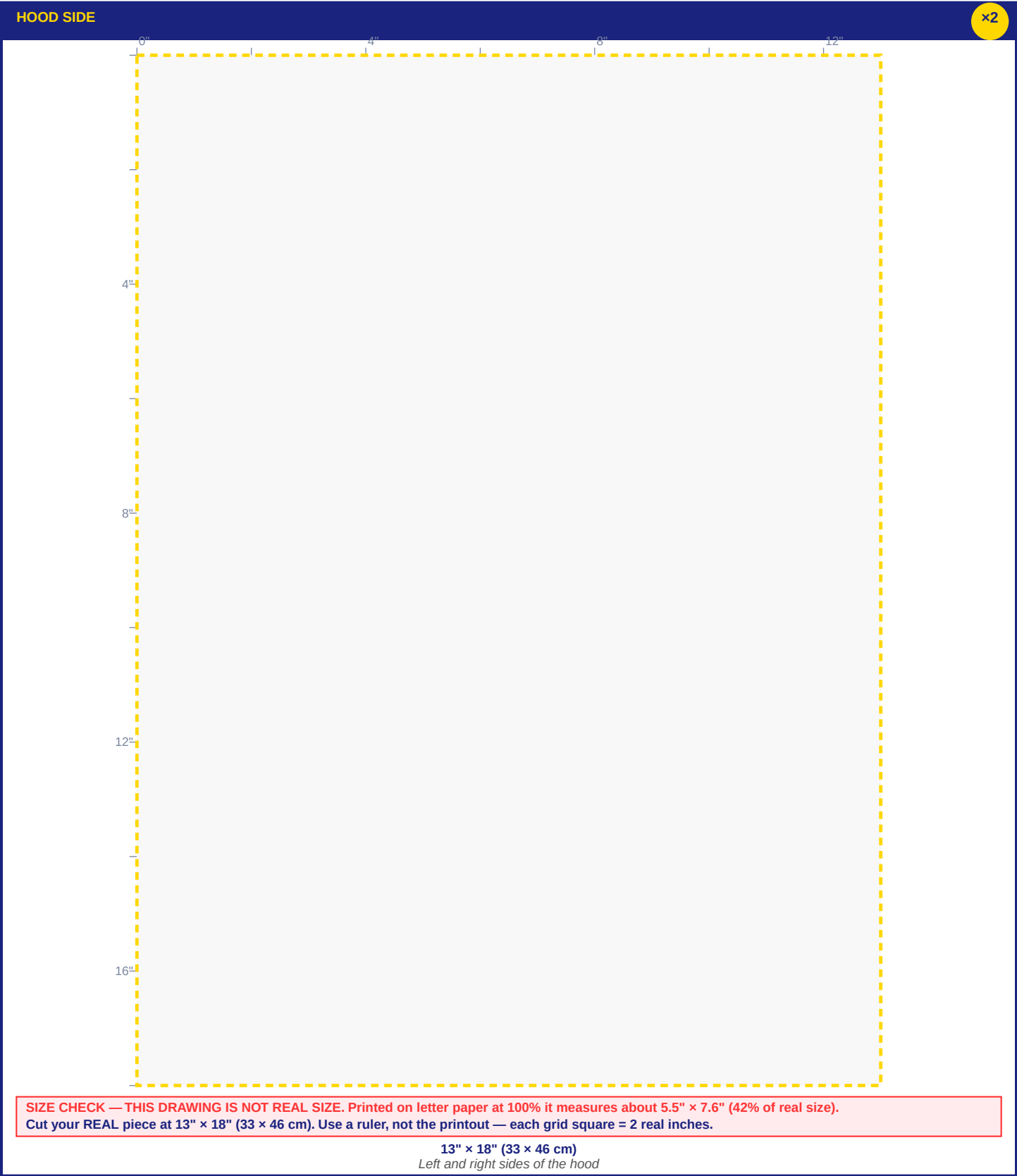
NOTE: The top of the hood, in front of the windshield



HOOD SIDE

13" × 18" (33 × 46 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2



MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

CUT — scissors or box cutter on this line

NOTE: Left and right sides of the hood



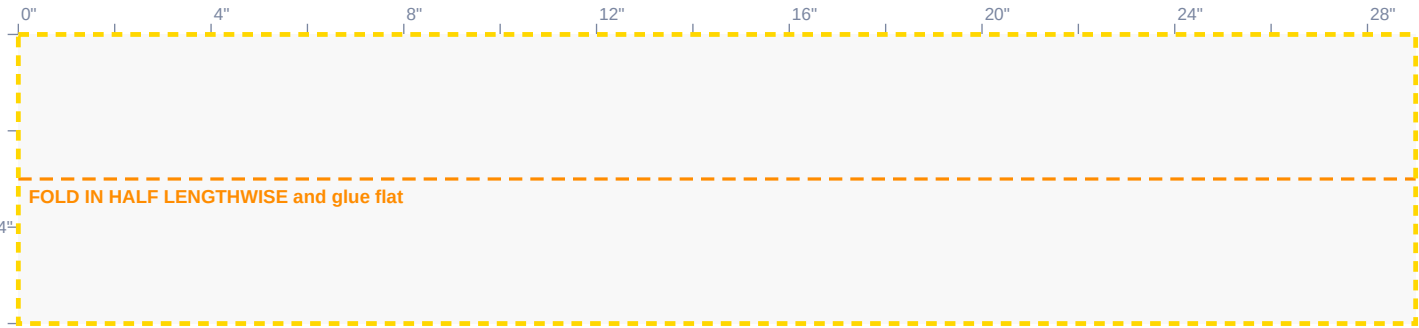
BUMPER

29" × 6" (74 × 15 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

BUMPER

×1



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 1.5" (25% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 29" × 6" (74 × 15 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

29" × 6" (74 × 15 cm)
Folds in half lengthwise: a 29" × 3" bumper, two layers thick

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Folds in half lengthwise: a 29" × 3" bumper, two layers thick



HEADLIGHT

5" × 5" (13 × 13 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2

HEADLIGHT

x2

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 6.9" × 6.9" (138% of real size — BIGGER than the Cut your REAL piece at 5" × 5" (13 × 13 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:
A circle 5" across. Trace the bottom of a cup or a roll of tape.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

5" × 5" (13 × 13 cm)
Circle

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

NOTE: Glue in the LIGHT boxes on the hood front



ROAD WHEEL

10" × 10" (25 × 25 cm) | Cut ×4

CUT
x4

ROAD WHEEL

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 6.9" × 6.9" (69% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 10" × 10" (25 × 25 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:
A circle 10" across. Pin a string 5" from the centre and swing a pencil right round, or trace a dinner plate that size. Cut 1, then trace it for the other 3.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

10" × 10" (25 × 25 cm)
Circle

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

NOTE: 2 a side: one under the cab, one under the rear body



HUBCAP

6" × 6" (15 × 15 cm) | Cut ×4

CUT
x4

HUBCAP

x4

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 6.9" × 6.9" (115% of real size — BIGGER than the REAL piece at 6" × 6" (15 × 15 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:
A circle 6" across. Trace a small plate or a lid that size, or pin a string 3" from the centre and swing a pencil right round.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

6" × 6" (15 × 15 cm)
Circle

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

NOTE: Glues on the middle of each road wheel



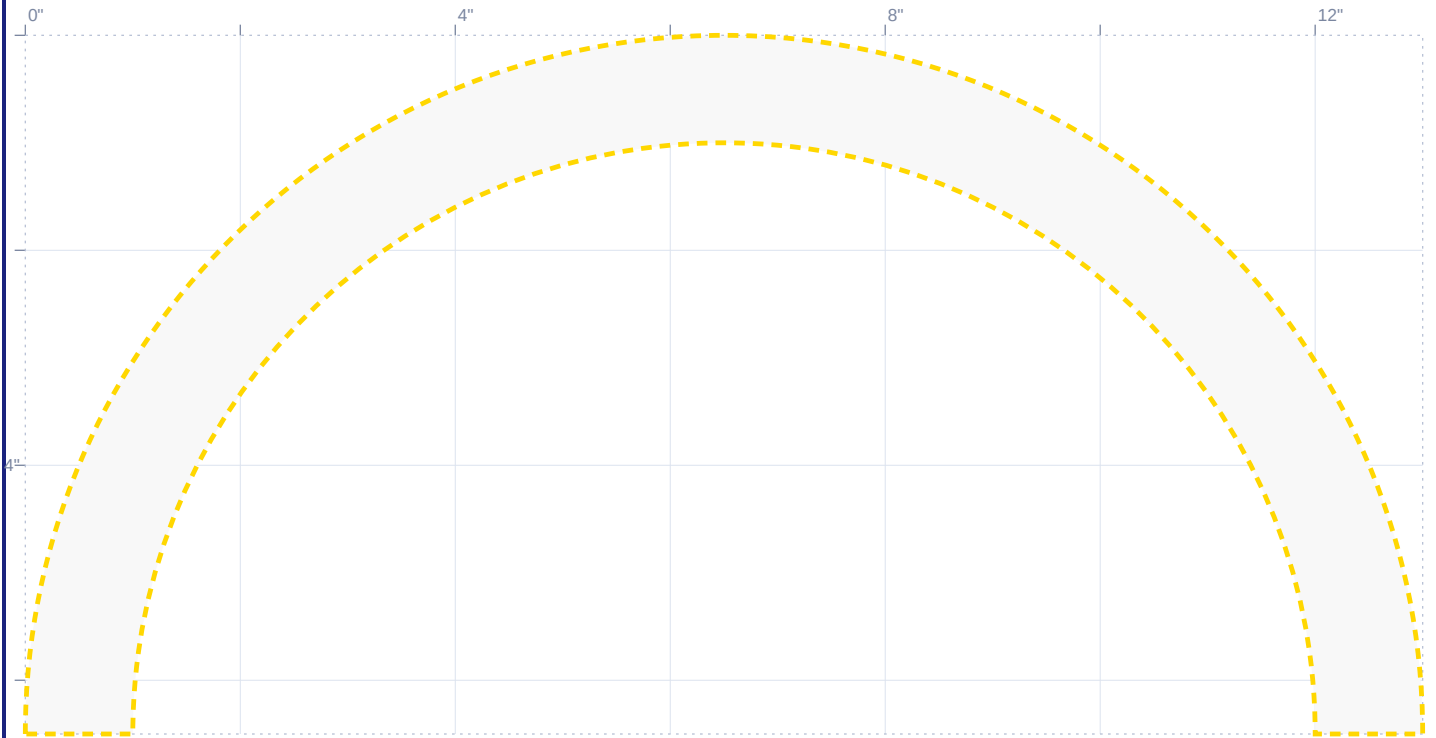
WHEEL ARCH

13" × 6.5" (33 × 17 cm) | Cut ×4

CUT
x4

WHEEL ARCH

x4



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 3.6" (56% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 13" × 6.5" (33 × 17 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:

Mark the middle of the long bottom edge. With a pencil on a string pinned there, swing a half circle 6.5" out, then a second one 5.5" out. Cut along both curves: a rainbow 1" wide. It sits over the top of a 10" wheel.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

13" × 6.5" (33 × 17 cm)

Rainbow — a half ring standing on its flat edge

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

NOTE: A raised lip over the top half of each wheel



4" x 3" (10 x 8 cm) | Cut x2

CUT

x2

x2



Cut your R

4" x 3" (10 x 8 cm)

Folds in half: a 4" handle, two layers thick, one per door

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Folds in half: a 4" handle, two layers thick, one per door



LADDER

21" × 5" (53 × 13 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2

LADDER

x2

0" 4" 8" 12" 16" 20"

4"

CUT OUT

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 1.7" (35% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 21" × 5" (53 × 13 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

21" × 5" (53 × 13 cm)
One along each side of the rear body

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

CUT OUT — cut along the red dashes (an orange side is a fold)

NOTE: One along each side of the rear body



LIGHT BAR TUBE

20" × 12" (51 × 30 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

LIGHT BAR TUBE

x1

0" 4" 8" 12" 16"

0" 1" 2" 3"

ROLL

ROLL so the two 20" edges overlap 1", then tape the seam

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 4.4" (36% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 20" × 12" (51 × 30 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

20" × 12" (51 × 30 cm)
Rolls into a tube 20" long, about 3.5" across

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

ROLL — roll the cardboard tightly in this direction

NOTE: Rolls into a tube 20" long, about 3.5" across

LIGHT BAR CAP

x2

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 6.9" × 6.9" (172% of real size — **BIGGER** than the real piece). Cut your **REAL** piece at 4" × 4" (10 × 10 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:

A circle 4" across. Trace a mug, or pin a string 2" from the centre.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

4" x 4" (10 x 10 cm)
Circle

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

NOTE: Closes each end of the light bar tube



STEERING COLUMN

8" × 8" (20 × 20 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

STEERING COLUMN

x1

0"

4"

SCORE 3 LINES 2" APART, fold into a square tube

4"

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 7.3" (91% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 8" × 8" (20 × 20 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

8" × 8" (20 × 20 cm)
Folds into a square tube 2" across that holds the wheel off the dash

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

SCORE — press hard with ruler but do NOT cut through

NOTE: Folds into a square tube 2" across that holds the wheel off the dash

Q

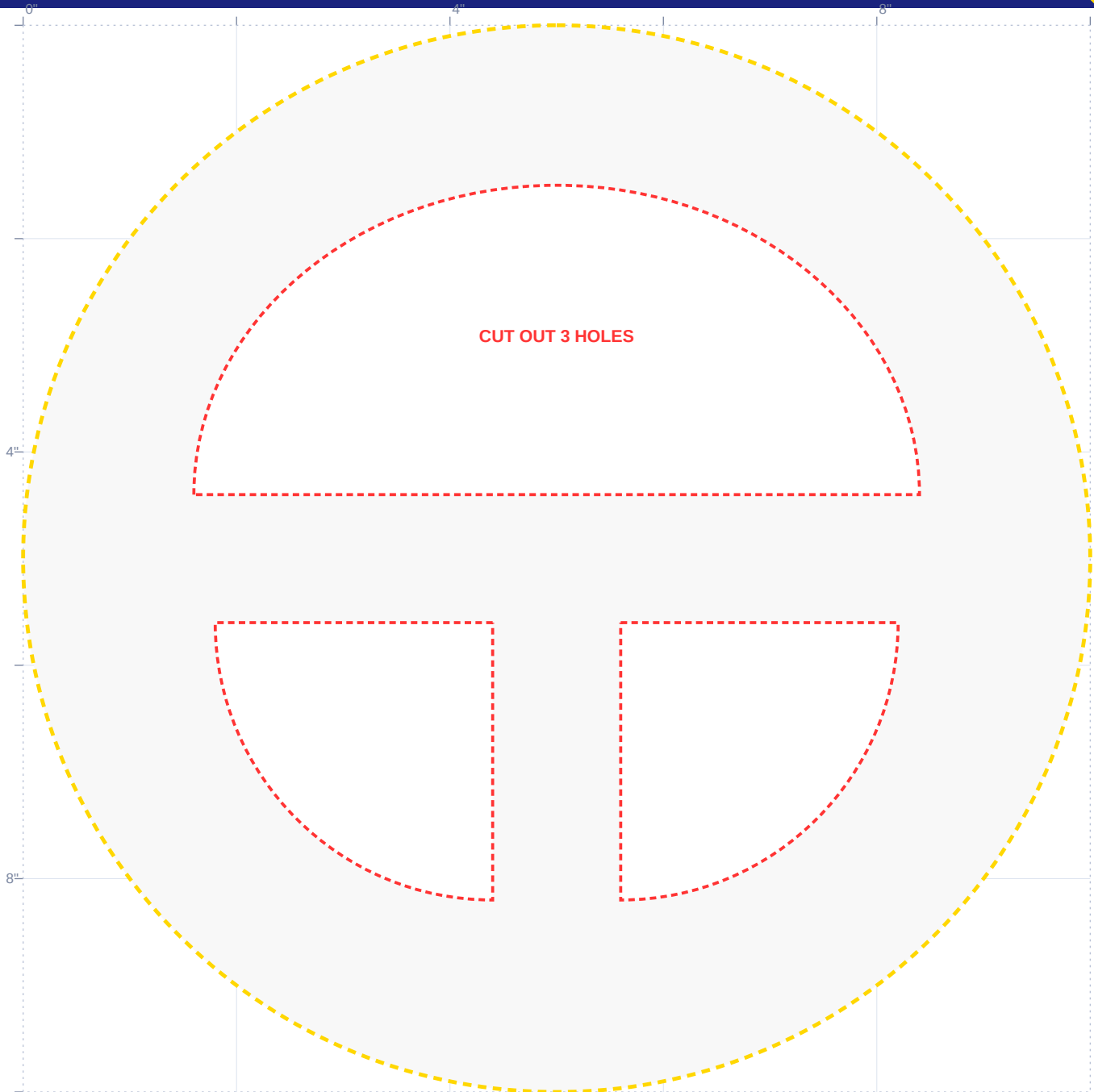
STEERING WHEEL LAYER

10" × 10" (25 × 25 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2

STEERING WHEEL LAYER

x2



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 6.9" × 6.9" (69% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 10" × 10" (25 × 25 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:

A circle 10" across (string 5" from the centre). Inside it cut the 3 red holes: a half-moon on top and two quarters below. That leaves a 1.5" rim, a hub and 3 spokes 1.2" wide. Cut 2 the same: 2 layers make 1 wheel.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

10" × 10" (25 × 25 cm)

Circle with 3 holes: rim, hub and 3 spokes

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

CUT OUT — cut along the red dashes (an orange side is a fold)

NOTE: Cut 2 the same and glue them together: 2 layers make 1 wheel



STEERING HUB

3" × 3" (8 × 8 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

STEERING HUB

x1

0"

3" × 3" (8 × 8 cm)
Circle

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 6.9" × 6.9" (230% of real size — BIGGER than the REAL piece at 3" × 3" (8 × 8 cm)). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:
A circle 3" across. Trace a jar lid or a roll of tape.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

NOTE: Glues on the middle of the wheel, where the 3 spokes meet



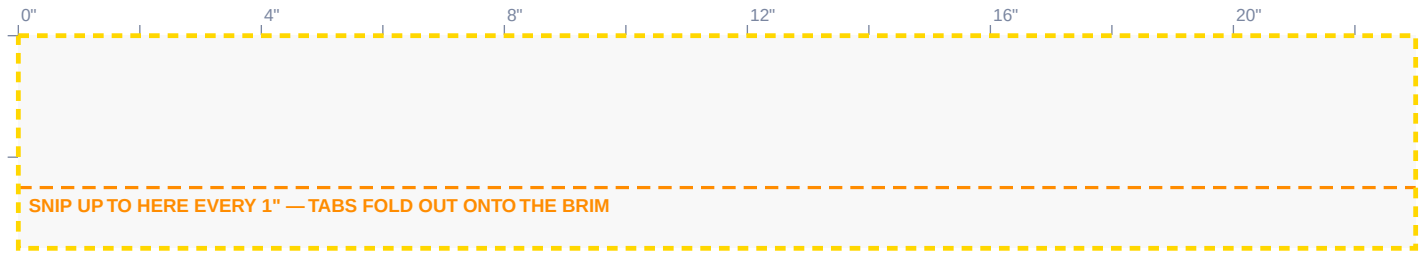
HELMET BAND

23" × 3.5" (58 × 9 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

HELMET BAND

×1



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 1.1" (32% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 23" × 3.5" (58 × 9 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

23" × 3.5" (58 × 9 cm)
Cut long on purpose: trim it to the child's head

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Cut long on purpose: trim it to the child's head



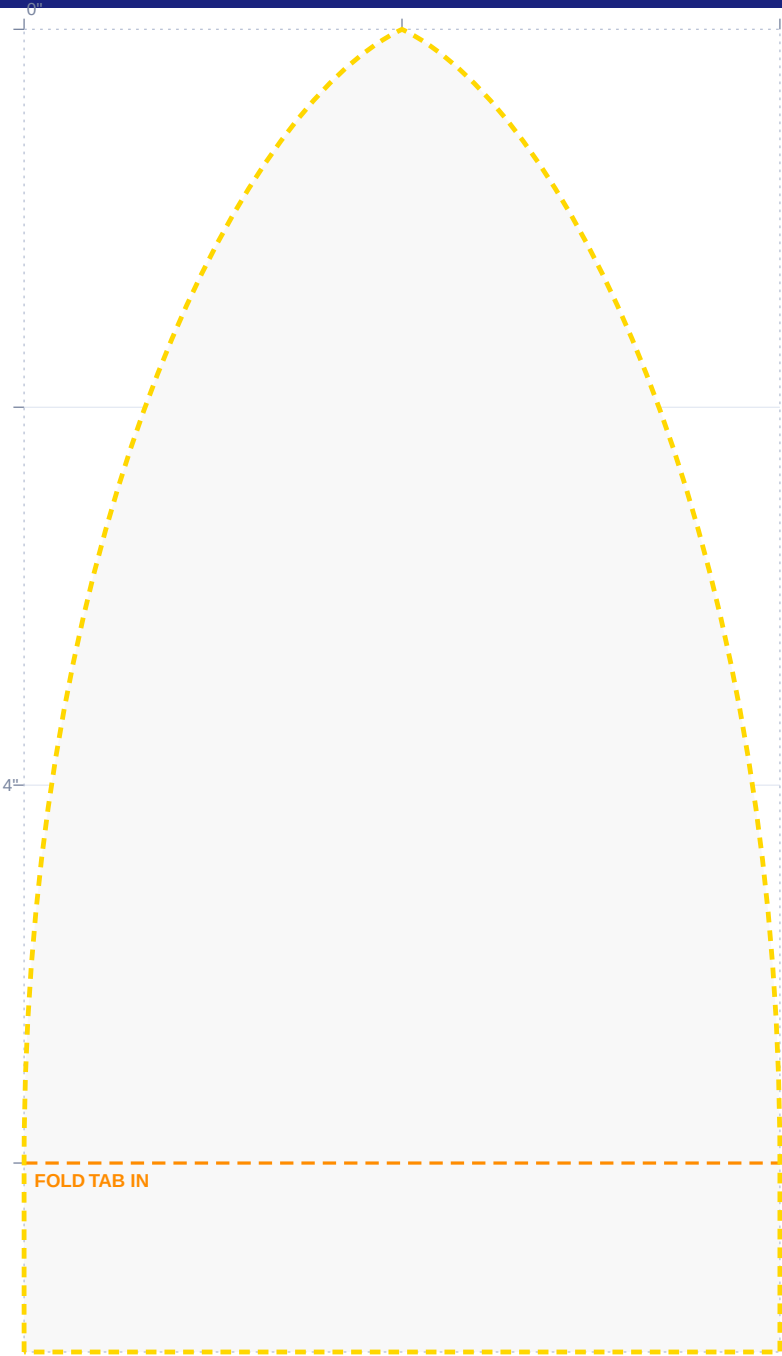
HELMET DOME PANEL

4" × 7" (10 × 18 cm) | Cut ×6

CUT
x6

HELMET DOME PANEL

×6



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 3.9" × 6.9" (98% of real size). Cut your REAL piece at 4" × 7" (10 × 18 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:

Draw a line 1" up from the bottom edge — that strip is the tab. Mark the centre of the top edge. From each end of the tab line, draw a smooth outward curve up to that centre mark (like one segment of an orange peel). Cut one, then trace it for the other five.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

4" × 7" (10 × 18 cm)

Dome panel — straight tab at the bottom, curved sides meeting in a point

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Six identical panels tape together into the top of the helmet



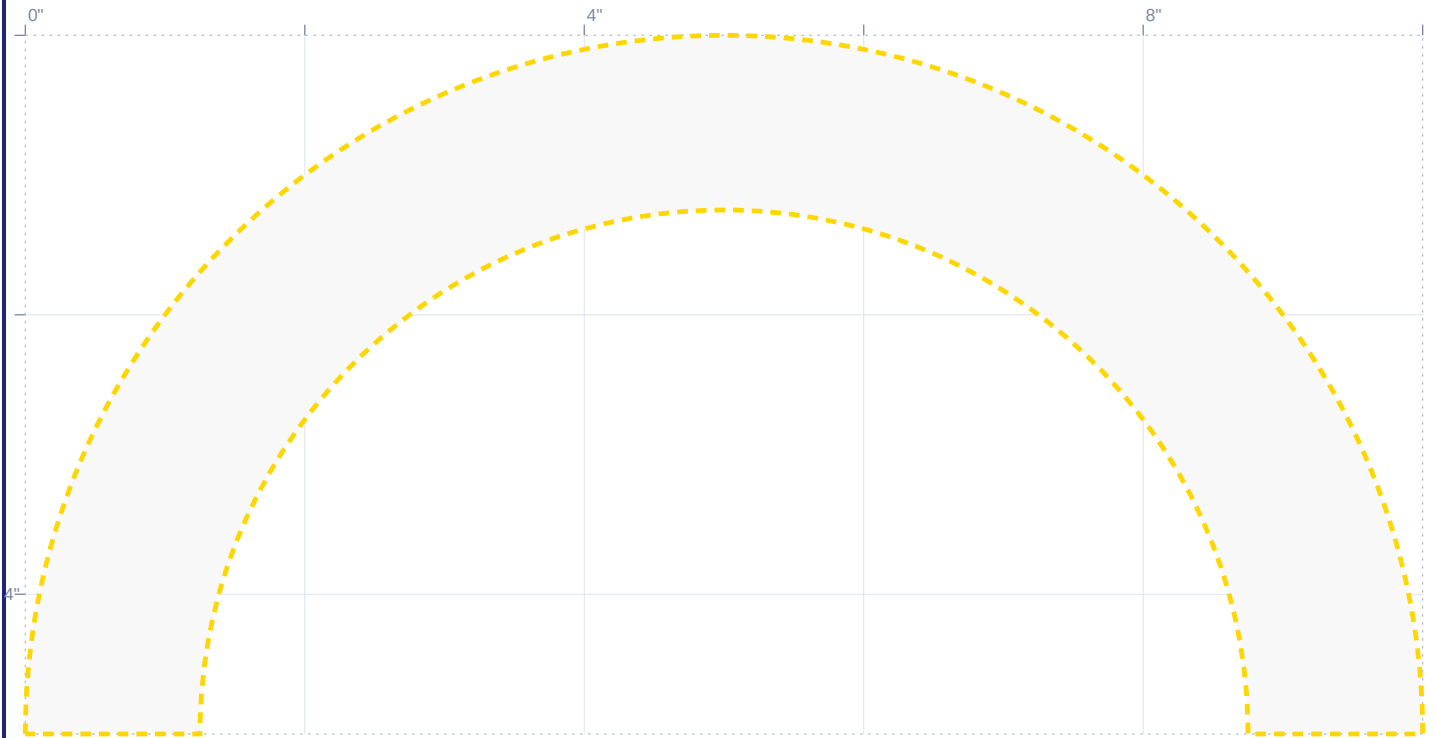
HELMET RIDGE

10" × 5" (25 × 13 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

HELMET RIDGE

×1



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 3.6" (73% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 10" × 5" (25 × 13 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:

Mark the middle of the long bottom edge. With a pencil on a string pinned there, swing a half circle 5" out, then a second one 3.8" out. Cut along both curves: a rainbow 1.3" wide. Its inner curve sits on the dome.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

10" × 5" (25 × 13 cm)

Ridge — a half ring that stands on edge over the dome

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

NOTE: The raised comb that runs over the top of the helmet, front to back



HELMET BRIM

12" × 14" (30 × 36 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

HELMET BRIM

x1

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 5.9" × 6.9" (49% of real size). Cut your REAL piece at 12" × 14" (30 × 36 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:
An oval 12" wide and 14" long: draw a cross through the middle, mark 6" out each way across and 7" out each way along, and join the 4 marks with a smooth curve. Then cut out the head opening drawn in red.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

12" × 14" (30 × 36 cm)
Oval brim — the head opening is cut out of the middle

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.	CUT OUT — cut along the red dashes (an orange side is a fold)
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NOTE: Goes all the way round, like the photo



HELMET BADGE PLATE

5" × 5" (13 × 13 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

HELMET BADGE PLATE

x1

0"

4"

4"

SCORE — bend to fit

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 6.9" × 6.9" (138% of real size — BIGGER than the REAL piece at 5" × 5" (13 × 13 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:
Keep the bottom edge and the lower 2.5" of both sides straight. Round the top half: trace round a 5" lid or bowl so the top is one smooth curve.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

5" × 5" (13 × 13 cm)
Badge plate — flat bottom, rounded top

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.	SCORE — press hard with ruler but do NOT cut through
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NOTE: The raised plate on the front of the helmet

WHAT YOU NEED — CARDBOARD FIRE TRUCK CAB

CARDBOARD PIECES — 23 TOTAL (4 Boxes (2 at least 24" × 36" (61 × 91 cm) + 2 used whole))

×1 Cab Box (full box) 27" × 36" <i>A washer or dryer box used whole: roof, walls and floor of the cab. Drawn: its LEFT side, front to the right</i>	×2 Ladder 21" × 5" <i>One along each side of the rear body</i>
×1 Rear Body (full box) 24" × 18" <i>A moving box about 24" × 18" × 18", used whole: the back of the truck. Drawn: its left side</i>	×1 Light Bar Tube 20" × 12" <i>Rolls into a tube 20" long, about 3.5" across</i>
×1 Windshield Frame 25" × 17" <i>Glues on the front of the cab — and is the stencil for the windshield hole</i>	×2 Light Bar Cap 4" × 4" <i>Closes each end of the light bar tube</i>
×1 Hood Front 27" × 18" <i>The front of the truck: grille, headlights and bumper go on it</i>	×1 Steering Column 8" × 8" <i>Folds into a square tube 2" across that holds the wheel off the dash</i>
×1 Hood Top 27" × 13" <i>The top of the hood, in front of the windshield</i>	×2 Steering Wheel Layer 10" × 10" <i>Cut 2 the same and glue them together: 2 layers make 1 wheel</i>
×2 Hood Side 13" × 18" <i>Left and right sides of the hood</i>	×1 Steering Hub 3" × 3" <i>Glues on the middle of the wheel, where the 3 spokes meet</i>
×1 Bumper 29" × 6" <i>Folds in half lengthwise: a 29" × 3" bumper, two layers thick</i>	×1 Helmet Band 23" × 3.5" <i>Cut long on purpose: trim it to the child's head</i>
×2 Headlight 5" × 5" <i>Glue in the LIGHT boxes on the hood front</i>	×6 Helmet Dome Panel 4" × 7" <i>Six identical panels tape together into the top of the helmet</i>
×4 Road Wheel 10" × 10" <i>2 a side: one under the cab, one under the rear body</i>	×1 Helmet Ridge 10" × 5" <i>The raised comb that runs over the top of the helmet, front to back</i>
×4 Hubcap 6" × 6" <i>Glues on the middle of each road wheel</i>	×1 Helmet Brim 12" × 14" <i>Goes all the way round, like the photo</i>
×4 Wheel Arch 13" × 6.5" <i>A raised lip over the top half of each wheel</i>	×1 Helmet Badge Plate 5" × 5" <i>The raised plate on the front of the helmet</i>
×2 Door Handle 4" × 3" <i>Folds in half: a 4" handle, two layers thick, one per door</i>	

TOOLS & SUPPLIES

- + 2 large boxes, sides at least 24" × 36"
- + Washer/dryer box, about 27" × 27" × 36"
- + Moving box, about 24" × 18" × 18"
- + Box cutter — ADULT USE ONLY
- + Heavy scissors for kids

- + Packing tape (3+ rolls) + white glue
- + Red paint — lots, it covers the truck
- + Tan, orange + dark-red paint, black marker
- + Ruler, pencil + string for circles

FUN FACT!

A real fire engine's pump moves at least 750 gallons of water a minute. Yours pumps 0 — but the bravery is the same.

CHALLENGE!

Fire drill! Set a 60-second timer. Can the whole family get to the fire truck and buckle in before the alarm goes off?

1

STEP 1: MARK OUT THE PIECES

Keep boxes A and B whole — they are the cab and the back of the truck. Flatten the two large boxes and mark out every other piece, C to W, from its template page, using the 2" (5 cm) grid and the sizes printed on each page. Draw every circle with a pencil on a string pinned at its centre.

2

STEP 2: CUT OUT THE PIECES

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Cut out every piece on its gold outline: C, D, E, 2 of F, G, 2 of H, 4 of I, 4 of J, 4 of K, 2 of L, 2 of M, N, 2 of O, P, 2 of Q, R, S, 6 of T, U, V and W. Also cut the holes drawn in red dashes on C, M, Q and V. Keep the off-cuts for patching.

SAFETY: Adult uses the box cutter, on a board. Cut circles in short strokes.

3

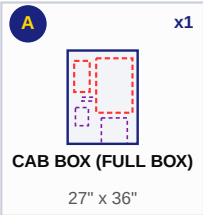
STEP 3: SET UP THE CAB BOX

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Tape the bottom flaps of the Cab Box shut, inside and out — that is the floor. Tape the top flaps shut too — that is the roof. Stand it 36" (91 cm) tall. Now cut its openings, using template A. LEFT side: the driver opening, 14" (36 cm) wide × 21" (53 cm) tall, 3" (8 cm) below the roof and 2" (5 cm) from the front edge, and the door window, 6" × 12" (15 × 30 cm), 2.5" (6 cm) from the back edge and 4" (10 cm) below the roof. Do the same on the right side, mirrored, so both openings are at the front. FRONT: a leg opening 16" (41 cm) wide and 12" (30 cm) tall, up from the bottom edge, 1" (3 cm) in from the left side — the legs stretch out under the hood. Tape over every cut edge.

SAFETY: Adult cuts. The sill is 12" up: help small children climb in.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



4

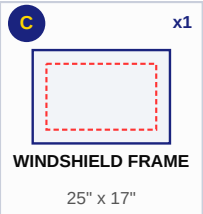
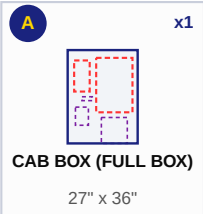
STEP 4: FIT THE WINDSHIELD FRAME

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Hold the Windshield Frame on the front of the Cab Box, 1" (3 cm) below the roof edge and 1" (3 cm) in from each side. Trace the inside of its opening, take it away, and cut the box along that line — a 20" (51 cm) by 12" (30 cm) hole. Glue and tape the frame back on over the hole.

SAFETY: Adult cuts the windshield hole.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

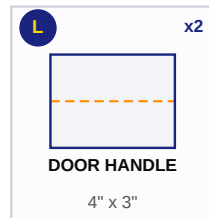


5

STEP 5: ADD THE DOOR HANDLES

With a black marker draw each door: a rectangle 9" (23 cm) wide and 32" (81 cm) tall, 1" (3 cm) from the back edge and 2" (5 cm) below the roof, with the door window inside it. Fold each Door Handle in half lengthwise and glue it flat. Glue one on each door in the small box on template A: 4" (10 cm) wide, 18" (46 cm) below the roof, ½" in from the door's front edge.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

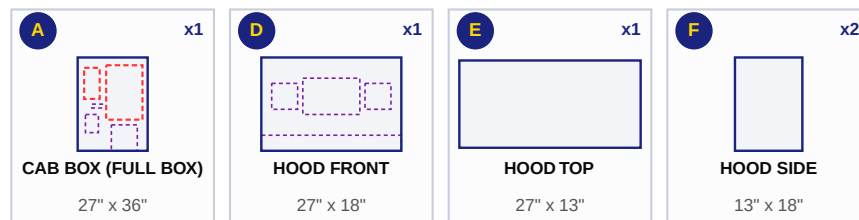


6

STEP 6: BUILD THE HOOD

Tape the two Hood Sides to the side edges of the Hood Front, inside and out, then tape the Hood Top across them: a box 27" (69 cm) wide, 18" (46 cm) tall and 13" (33 cm) deep, with no back and no bottom. Push it against the front of the Cab Box, centred over the leg opening, and tape every join to the cab inside and out.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

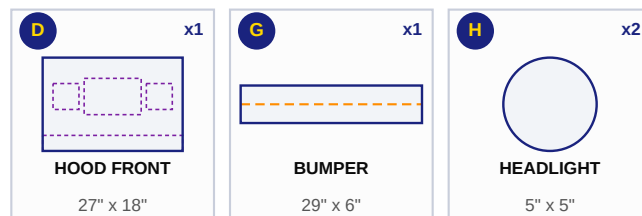


7

STEP 7: ADD THE BUMPER AND HEADLIGHTS

Fold the Bumper in half lengthwise and glue it flat. Glue it across the bottom of the Hood Front (BUMPER box), sticking out 1" (3 cm) past each side. Glue a Headlight in each LIGHT box: 2" (5 cm) in from each side, 5" (13 cm) below the top edge.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

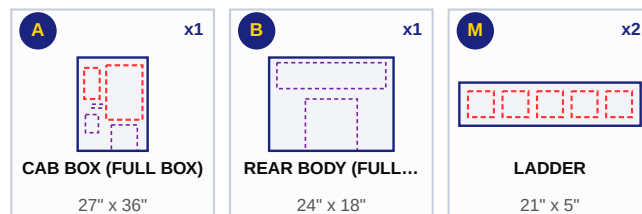


8

STEP 8: ADD THE REAR BODY

Tape the flaps of the Rear Body shut and lay it so it is 24" (61 cm) long and 18" (46 cm) tall. Push one end against the back of the Cab Box, centred, and tape every join. Glue a Ladder flat on each side, 1" (3 cm) below the top edge and 1.5" (4 cm) from each end (LADDER box on template B).

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

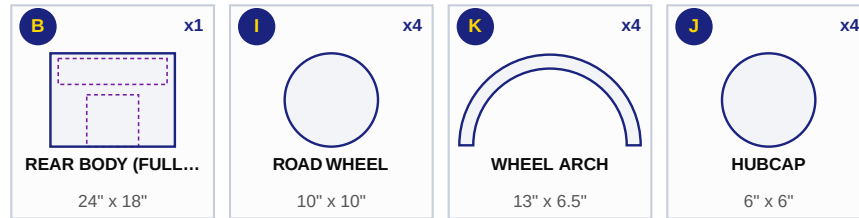


9

STEP 9: FIT THE WHEELS

Glue a Hubcap on the middle of each Road Wheel. On each side, glue one wheel on the cab, centred 18" (46 cm) from the back of the cab with its edge touching the floor (ROAD WHEEL box on template A), and one on the middle of the Rear Body, touching the floor. Glue a Wheel Arch over the top half of every wheel, its flat ends level with the middle of the wheel and a ½" gap all the way round, like the photo.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

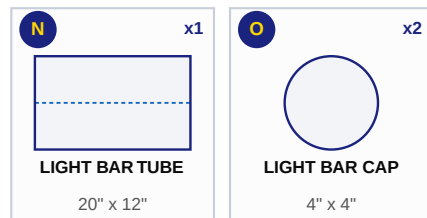


10

STEP 10: MOUNT THE LIGHT BAR

Roll the Light Bar Tube so its two 20" (51 cm) edges overlap 1" (3 cm) and tape the seam: a tube 20" (51 cm) long, about 3.5" (9 cm) across. Tape a Light Bar Cap over each end. Lay it across the roof with its middle 4" (10 cm) back from the front edge, centred side to side, and tape it down along both sides.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



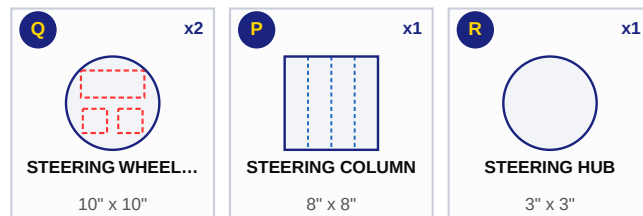
11

STEP 11: BUILD THE STEERING WHEEL

Glue the two Steering Wheel Layers together with the holes lined up, then glue the Steering Hub on the middle of the front. Score the Steering Column on its 3 lines, fold it into a square tube 2" (5 cm) across and tape the seam. Snip 1" (3 cm) into each corner at one end and fold the 4 flaps out. Glue the flaps inside the cab front, 9" (23 cm) in from the left wall and 17" (43 cm) up from the floor — between the leg opening and the windshield. Glue the back of the wheel to the other end.

SAFETY: The wheel must not block the way in or out of the driver opening.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



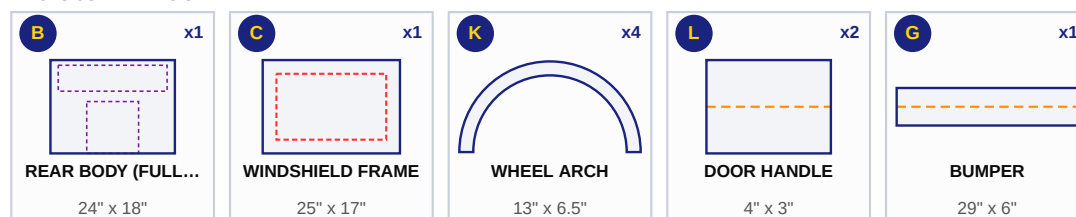
12

STEP 12: PAINT FIRE ENGINE RED

Paint every outside surface red, like the photo: the cab, the hood, the rear body, the windshield frame, the door handles, the ladders and the wheel arches. Leave the wheels, hubcaps, headlights, bumper, steering wheel and helmet plain cardboard. Let it dry.

SAFETY: Water-based paint only, in a ventilated space.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

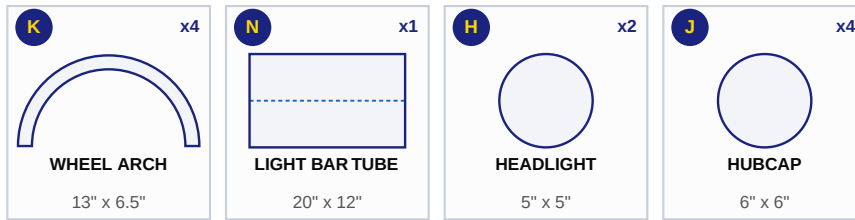


13

STEP 13: PAINT THE DETAILS

Badges: in the BADGE box on each door paint a shield 5" (13 cm) wide and 7" (18 cm) tall (flat top, straight sides for 4" (10 cm), then curving to a point at the bottom) with a tan outline, orange inside and a tan flame about 4" (10 cm) tall in the middle. Grille: in the GRILLE box on template D paint a rectangle a shade darker than the red, and 4 dark-red lines across it 1.4" (4 cm) apart. Light bar: paint 7" (18 cm) at each end red and leave the middle 6" (15 cm) plain. Paint the edge of every wheel arch and the door outlines dark red. Draw a dark ring just inside the edge of each headlight and hubcap.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



14

STEP 14: BUILD THE HELMET BAND

Snip the bottom edge of the Helmet Band up to its fold line every 1" (3 cm), making tabs. The band is 23" (58 cm) long on purpose — longer than any child's head (19.5–22.5" (50–57 cm) round for ages 3–10). Wrap it round the child's head just above the eyebrows, overlap the ends 1" (3 cm), mark the spot, trim both ends and tape the seam at the back.

SAFETY: Snug, not tight: a finger must slide under the band.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

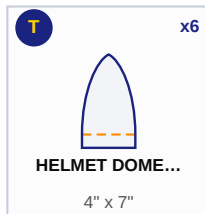


15

STEP 15: BUILD THE HELMET DOME

Fold the tab of each of the 6 Helmet Dome Panels inward. Tape the tabs inside the top edge of the band, side by side all the way round, overlapping a little where they meet. Bend the panels in so their curved edges meet over the head and tape every seam up to the top. The top of the helmet is now round, like the photo.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



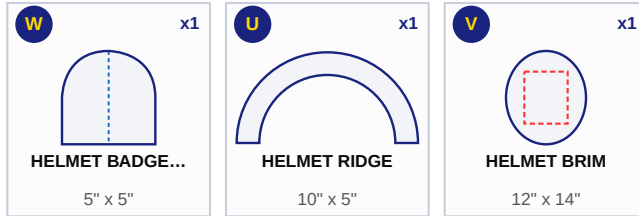
16

STEP 16: ADD THE BRIM, RIDGE AND BADGE PLATE

Slide the Helmet Brim up over the band from below until it reaches the tab line, fold the tabs out flat onto the brim and glue them down. Stand the Helmet Ridge on its flat edge along the middle of the dome, front to back, its inner curve on the dome, and tape both sides. Bend the Helmet Badge Plate along its score line and glue it on the front, flat end on the brim, centred under the ridge. Leave the helmet plain cardboard like the photo.

SAFETY: Check the child can see clearly and turn the head with it on.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



17

STEP 17: QUALITY CHECK

The child climbs in, sits on the floor with legs under the hood, holds the 3-spoke wheel and leans out of the driver opening. Roof on, light bar on top, door window, handle and badge on both sides, 4 wheels in their arches, ladders on the rear body, grille, headlights and bumper on the front. Helmet: round dome, ridge, badge plate, brim all round. Compare to the cover photo. That's the standard.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



QUALITY CHECK!

Does your build match the cover photo? Compare side by side before you call it done.

"Build It. Own It." — Tatum & Kash Cardboard Creations